

DATA ANALYTICS CASE STUDY PROJECT – AMIT SHARMA

Update for the Workforce Diversity Steering Committee: Equal Part-Time Workforce Representation

A data-driven update on full-time and part-time employment across the NSW public sector, 2014–2018.

1,891,836 Employee Headcount

10 clusters

92 agencies

Purpose & Scope of This Update

This update, prepared for the Workforce Diversity Steering Committee, examines equal part-time workforce representation across the NSW public sector, the focus named in the discussion paper. It draws on five years of workforce data, by gender, cluster and employment type, to give the Committee a clear, evidence-based basis for that conversation.

This update covers:

Headcount and gender representation trends, 2014–2018

Part-time employment rates, sector-wide and by cluster

The gender gap within part-time work, cluster by cluster

A straight-line projection of part-time representation to 2025

 **1,891,836**

Employee Headcount across the sector
(2014-2018)

 **10**

Government clusters

 **92**

Individual agencies

 **2014–18**

Years of workforce data analysed

Sector

All agencies and people who work directly for the NSW Government.

Cluster

A group of agencies that share a function and report to one Secretary.

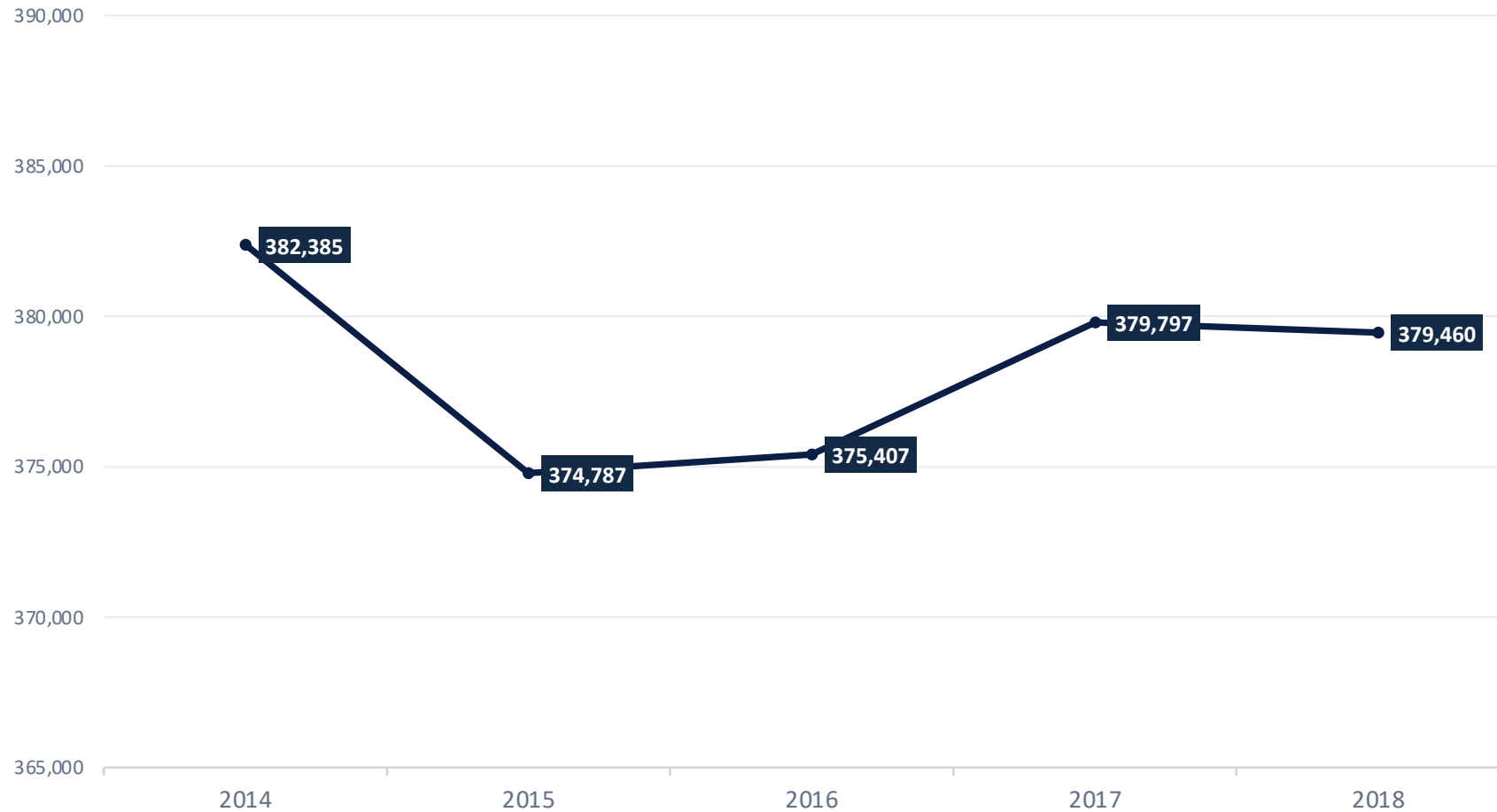
Headcount

The number of employees, counted as individual people.

pp

Percentage point — the unit used to describe change in a %.

Sector Headcount Fell – Mainly Due to a Drop in Male Employees



▲ +0.52%

Female headcount growth, 2014–2018

▼ -3.05%

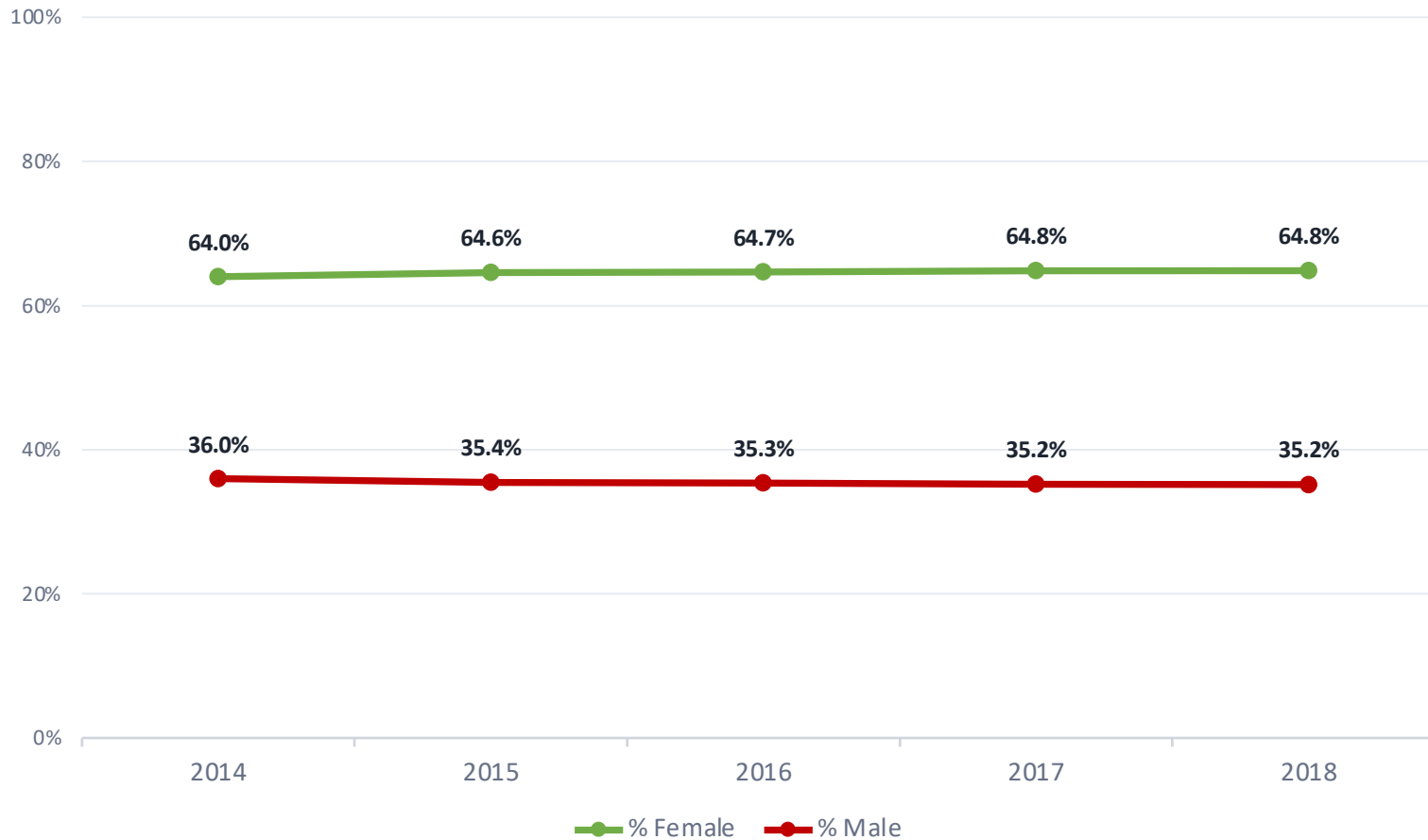
Male headcount growth, 2014–2018

▼ -0.76%

Total sector headcount growth, 2014–2018

Between 2014 and 2018, the NSW public sector decreased in size. However, this decrease was mainly due to a drop in the number of male employees, down by more than 4,000 (4,198), while female headcount increased by around 1,300 (1,273) over the same period.

Female Employees Remain Roughly Two-Thirds of the Sector



64.0% → 64.8%

Female share of the sector, 2014 vs 2018

36.0% → 35.2%

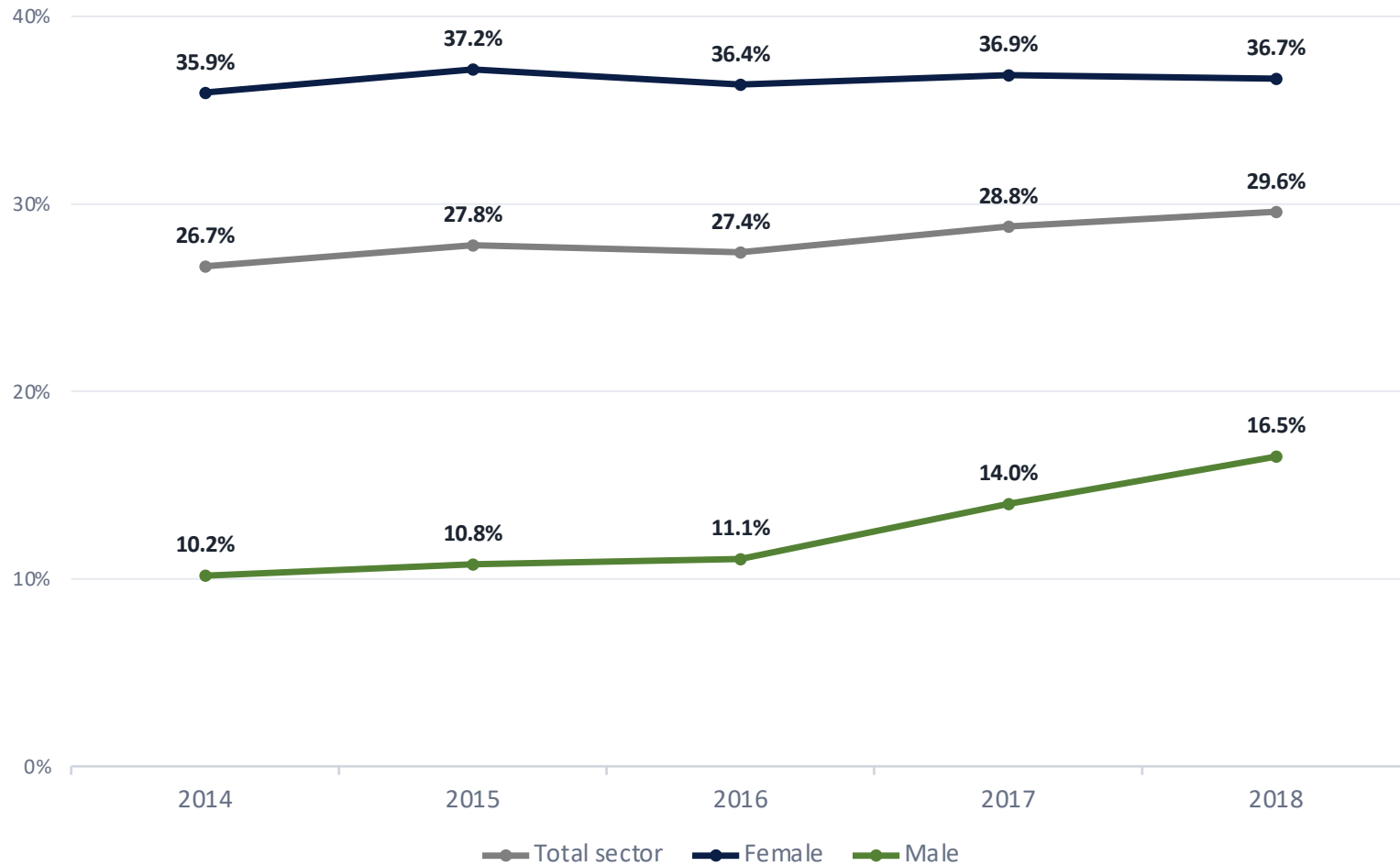
Male share of the sector, 2014 vs 2018



Female representation has edged higher every year since 2014, continuing a long-standing pattern in the sector's gender composition.



Part-Time Work Is Rising — Fastest Among Men



26.7% → 29.6% (+2.9pp)

Total Sector

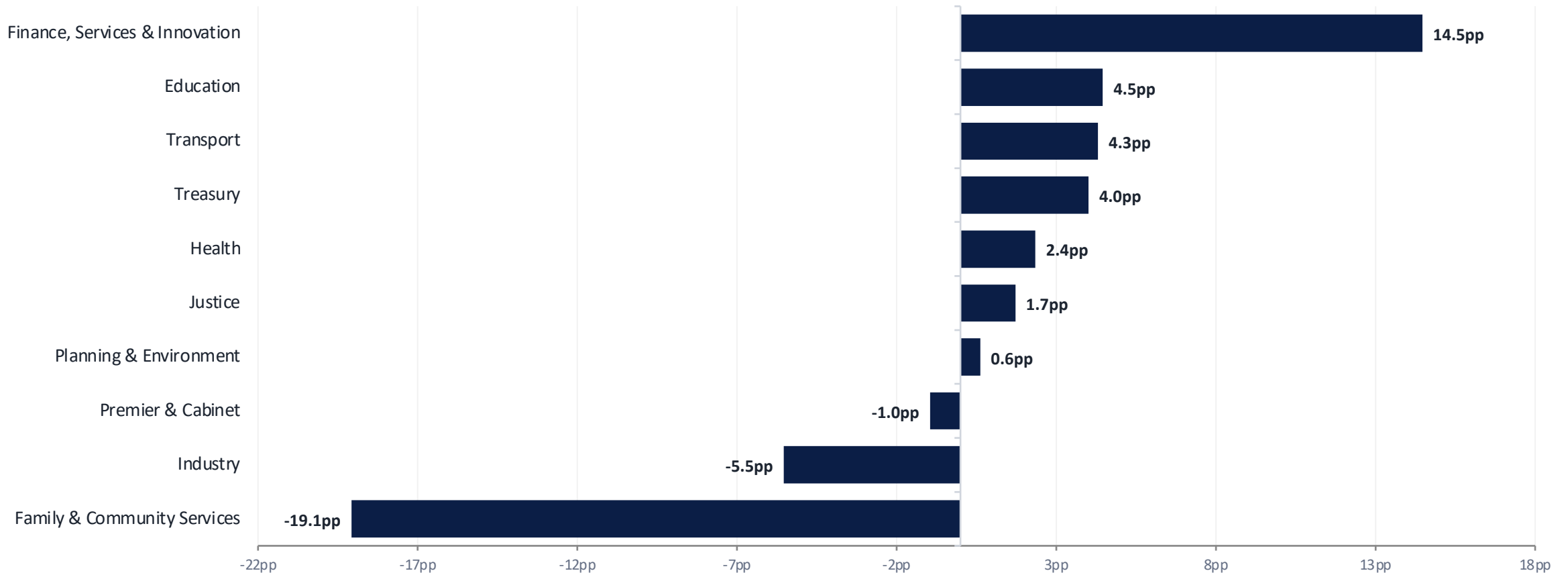
35.9% → 36.7% (+0.7pp)

Female

10.2% → 16.5% (+6.3pp)

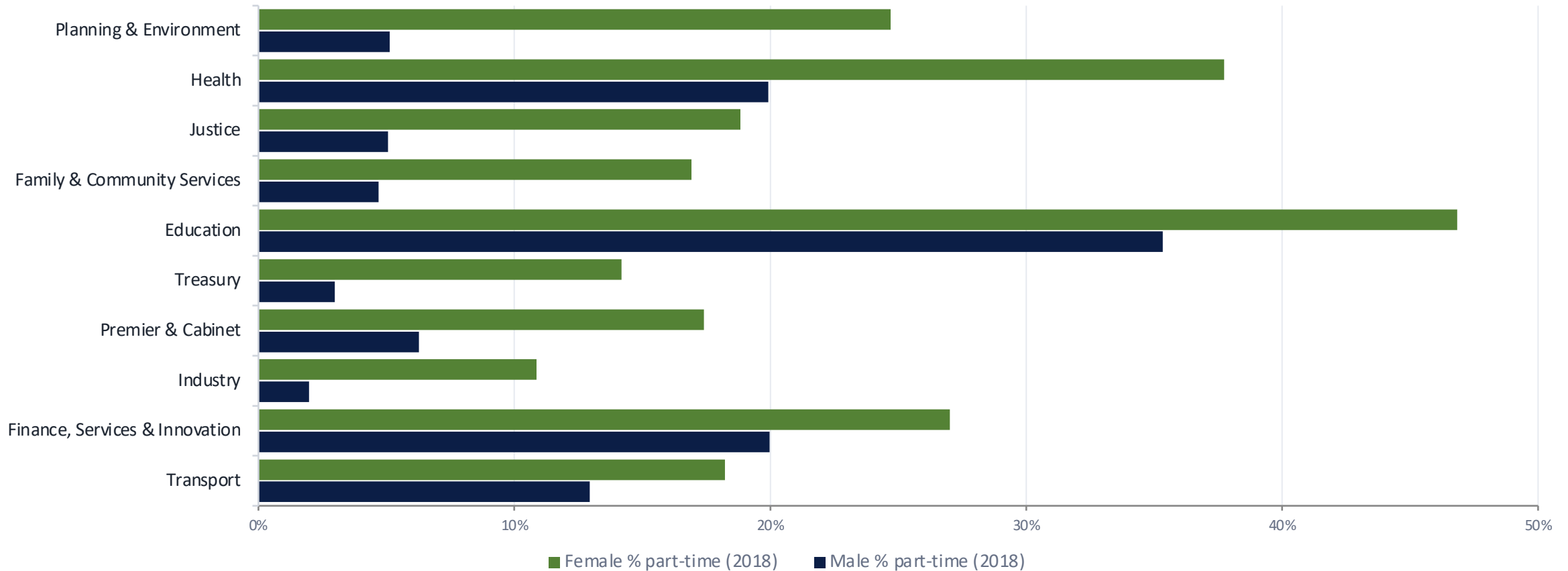
Male

Part-Time Growth Is Concentrated in a Few Clusters



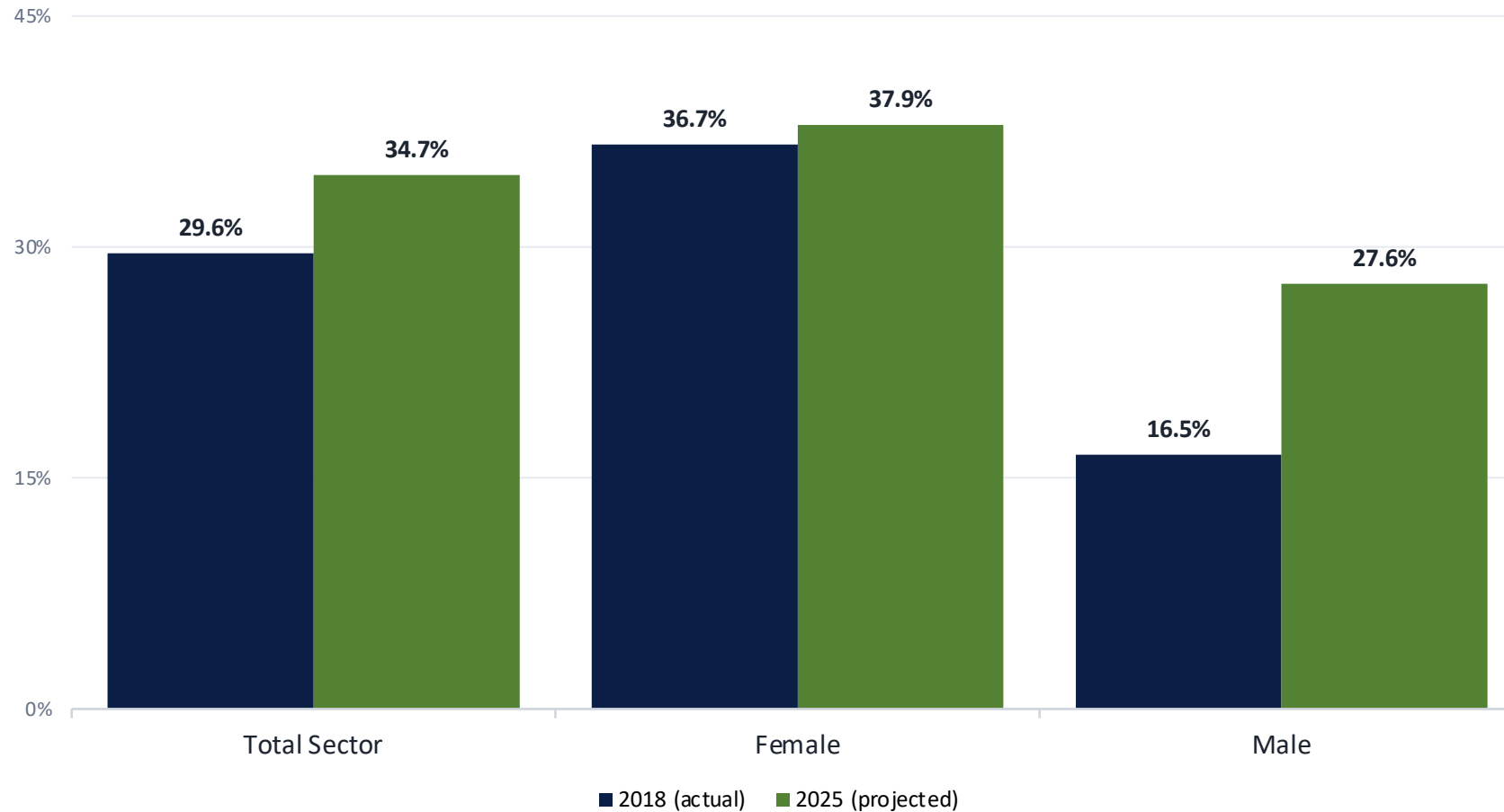
Finance, Services & Innovation and Education recorded the largest gains. Family & Community Services moved sharply the other way, falling 19 points, the sector's only double-digit decline. Education is the only cluster with more than 40% part-time employees (44.20%), with female part-time employees making up 46.8% of all female employees and male part-time employees making up 35.3% of all male employees.

Part-Time Uptake Is Not Shared Equally by Gender



In every cluster, women are more likely than men to work part-time, but by how much varies widely, from a 5-point gap in Transport to nearly 20 points in Planning & Environment.

If Current Trends Continue, to 2025



34.7%

Projected total sector part-time rate, 2025

37.9%

Projected female part-time rate, 2025

27.6%

Projected male part-time rate, 2025

On this straight-line basis, the gender gap in part-time rates narrows from 20 points today to roughly 10 by 2025, a meaningful shift, but not full convergence.

Ten Clusters, Ten Different Trajectories

Finance, Services
& Innovation

+14.5pp



Education

+4.5pp



Transport

+4.3pp



Treasury

+4.0pp



Health

+2.4pp



Justice

+1.7pp



Planning &
Environment

+0.6pp



Premier &
Cabinet

-0.9pp



Industry

-5.5pp



Family &
Community Services

-19.1pp



Caution: several clusters, Family & Community Services most sharply, moved unevenly rather than in a straight line. Extending its trend directly would put it below zero within a few years, a modelling artefact rather than a real outcome. Cluster-level projections deserve more caution than the sector-wide figures.



Discussion Points for the Committee



Education's outsized role

Education is the only cluster above 40% part-time and the single largest contributor to the sector-wide increase. Does this reflect the availability of part-time roles, workforce demand, or both?



Rising male part-time uptake

Male part-time representation grew from 10.2% to 16.5% in four years, even as full-time male headcount fell. What is driving this shift?



Uneven progress across clusters

The gender gap in part-time rates ranges from 5 points in Transport to nearly 20 in Planning & Environment. Should clusters furthest from equal representation be prioritised?



The road to 2025

Even on current trends, a real gender gap in part-time rates is projected to remain in 2025. What further steps, if any, should the Committee consider?